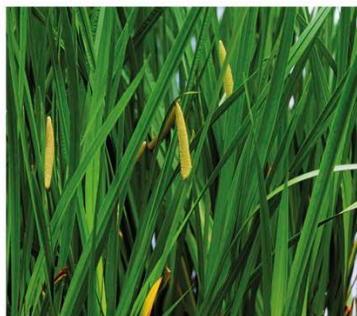




Plants for pond perimeters

Plants that enjoy cool, damp soil at the water's edge are known as bog plants and include flowers such as iris, cardinal flower, and many forms of primrose.

Bog plants not only add interest to a garden, they also help develop and maintain habitats for the wildlife. If you have an artificial pond the water is contained, so the surrounding soil will be the same as elsewhere in the garden. However, you can replicate naturally occurring boggy conditions by digging out an area around your pond, lining it with pond liner punctured with a few drainage holes, and replacing the excavated soil, enriched with some organic material, on top of the liner. Remember to water the area well during dry spells.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Acorus calamus

SWEET FLAG This is an upright deciduous or semievergreen perennial marginal with grasslike green leaves and spikes of small, insignificant brown flowers in summer. Plant it in shallow water or in a bog garden.

↑3ft (1m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z4–10 (N)



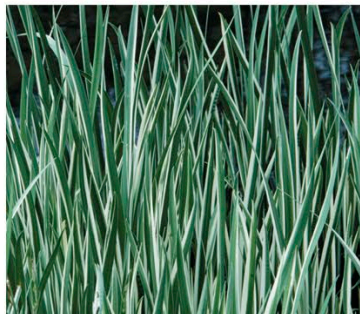
PERENNIAL LARGE

Aruncus dioicus

GOATSBEAR This form of goatsbeard is a tall, clump-forming perennial with large light green leaves divided into smaller leaflets. In midsummer, it produces arching stems that carry plumes of tiny, creamy white flowers.

↑6ft (2m) ↔4ft (1.2m)

☀ Z3–7 (N)



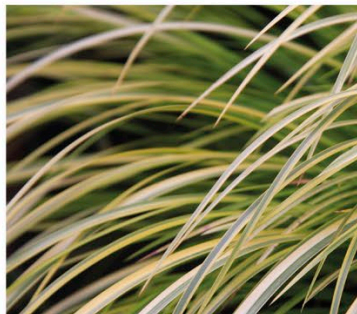
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Acorus calamus 'Variegatus'

SWEET FLAG This upright deciduous or semievergreen perennial marginal produces swordlike cream-variegated leaves that are flushed rose-pink in spring. It forms a large clump that can be divided in spring.

↑30in (75cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z4–10 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

Acorus gramineus

GRASSY-LEAVED SWEET FLAG This is a compact semievergreen perennial marginal for bogs or ponds that produces grasslike dark green leaves. Popular varieties include 'Ogon' (above), which has attractively striped, creamy-yellow foliage.

↑10in (25cm) ↔6in (15cm)

☀ Z5–9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astilbe chinensis

ASTILBE This is a clump-forming perennial with deeply cut dark green leaves. In late summer, it produces upright plumes of tiny pink-white flowers. *A. chinensis* var. *pumila* has deep pink-red blooms. Keep it well watered.

↑24in (60cm) ↔8in (20cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astilbe x ardensii 'Fanal'

ASTILBE This is a medium-sized, clump-forming perennial with deeply divided, fernlike dark green foliage. In midsummer, feathery dark pink flower heads appear on slim stems. Prefers rich soil; also grows well in shade.

↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z3–8



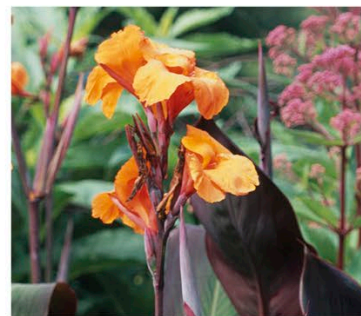
BULB LARGE

Camassia leichtlinii

QUAMASH An upright deciduous bulb with long, narrow, erect lower leaves, and tall spikes of starry creamy white blooms from late spring to early summer. It flowers later than most camassias, extending its season. 'Semiplena' (above) has semidouble blooms.

↑5ft (1.5m)

☀ Z5–9 (N)



PERENNIAL LARGE

Canna 'Wyoming'

CANNA An erect perennial with decorative foliage and flowers. It produces large, oval purple-bronze leaves with darker purple veins, and gladiolus-like, pale orange flowers from midsummer to early fall. Lift the rhizomes in fall to overwinter.

↑6ft (1.8m) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ Z8–11